MOM TRIED THESE

FREE GUIDE, 2026

The Christmas Gift *Shortlist*, by Age

Gifts for kids 6 to 10 that still get played with in January. Five picks per age, and the reason each one is there.

BEFORE YOU START

Two rules that do most of the work

1. The January test

Ask one question about every gift: will this still be out of the box in January? Not on Christmas morning, when everything is exciting. In January, when school is back and the novelty is gone. If you're not sure, it's probably no.

Usually passes: things they build and rebuild, art supplies that feel real, games the family plays after dinner, the next book in a series they love.
Usually fails: anything that does one trick, anything bought because it was on sale, the fifth of something they already have.

2. Four gifts, each with a job

Want
The thing on their list, in their handwriting.

Need
Something they'll use every day. Boring to buy, loved to use.

Read
A book in a series they already love, so it gets finished.

Do
Something to make or play together. The one they remember.

> How to use this guide: find the age, pick two, and stop. One good thing they love beats ten things they open and forget. Every pick links to the full list on our site, with more options and prices for the UAE and the US.

6

GIFTS FOR 6 YEAR OLDS

Six wants to do it themselves. Everything here, they can start and finish alone.



IF THEY BUILD

LEGO Creator 3-in-1 Space Shuttle

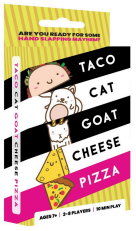
Three builds from one box: a shuttle, an astronaut or a spaceship. Rebuilds keep it alive past day one.



IF THEY MAKE

Skillmatics Aqua Puffs Animals

Paint by number with puffy paint that rises as it dries. No mess on the table.



IF THEY PLAY

Taco Cat Goat Cheese Pizza

Say the words, slap the card. Five minutes a round and the adults laugh too.



IF THEY READ, OR LISTEN

Dog Man, Book 15

Comic-style and silly. Read under the covers with a torch.



IF MINECRAFT IS THEIR WHOLE PERSONALITY

LEGO Minecraft Steve's Taiga Adventure

A small, fast build. Good first Minecraft LEGO for a 6-year-old.

See the full list for 6 year olds → momtriedthese.com/journal/gifts-for-6-year-olds

7

GIFTS FOR 7 YEAR OLDS

Seven wants it a bit hard. Not too easy, not cupboard-by-dinner hard.



IF THEY BUILD

LEGO Creator 3-in-1 Spider

A big spider that rebuilds into a scorpion or a snake. For the kid who loves creepy things.



IF THEY MAKE

Funcils Watercolour Set

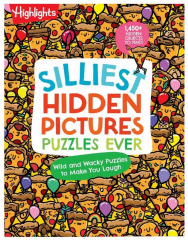
We bought this one. A hundred colours in a tin, with brushes. Feels like a real artist's kit, not a toy.



IF THEY PLAY

Bananagrams

Speed crosswords from a zip pouch. Packs into anything.



IF THEY READ

Silliest Hidden Pictures Puzzles Ever

A seek-and-find book with over a thousand things to spot. Quiet for ages.



FOR THE MINECRAFT FAN

LEGO Minecraft Baby Pig House

A cute pig-shaped house that opens up. Younger fans love it.

See the full list for 7 year olds → momtriedthese.com/journal/gifts-for-7-year-olds

8

GIFTS FOR 8 YEAR OLDS

Eight wants to know how things work, and to win at cards.



IF THEY LIKE TO KNOW HOW THINGS WORK

Snap Circuits Jr. SC-100

Real electronics with snap-together parts. Over a hundred projects, from a fan to an alarm.



IF THEY MAKE

Glow in the Dark Rock Painting Kit

Paint the rocks, then watch them glow at bedtime. Comes with everything, so no hunting for supplies.



IF THEY PLAY

Flip 7

A press-your-luck card game. Easy rules, dramatic finishes.



IF THEY READ

Diary of a Wimpy Kid, Book 21

The new Wimpy Kid. A guaranteed quiet Christmas afternoon.



FOR THE MINECRAFT FAN

LEGO Minecraft Zombie Dungeon 21587

A dungeon build with zombies and traps. Lots of play after the build.

See the full list for 8 year olds → momtriedthese.com/journal/gifts-for-8-year-olds

9

GIFTS FOR 9 YEAR OLDS

Nine wants real projects: things that move, grow, or take a whole afternoon.



IF THEY BUILD

CrunchLabs Crunchinator

A Mark Rober build that crushes things on purpose. Engineering, with a payoff.



IF THEY LIKE SCIENCE

National Geographic Break Open 10 Geodes

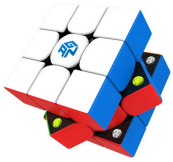
Crack a rock, find crystals inside. Every one is different.



IF THEY PLAY

Monopoly Deal

All the fun of Monopoly in 15 minutes. Nobody storms off.



FOR THE QUIET, SOLO HOURS

GAN Magnetic Speed Cube

For the kid who just found cubing videos. Turns smoother than a regular cube, so they don't give up.



FOR THE MINECRAFT FAN

LEGO Minecraft The Skeleton 21594

A big buildable skeleton for older fans who like to display what they build.

See the full list for 9 year olds → momtriedthese.com/journal/gifts-for-9-year-olds

10

GIFTS FOR 10 YEAR OLDS

Ten wants to be taken seriously. Real tools, real experiments, games for the whole table.



IF THEY WANT TO CODE

Apitor Coding Robot

Build the robot, then code it from a tablet with blocks. Screen time that makes something.



IF THEY LIKE EXPERIMENTS

National Geographic Magic Chemistry Set

Ten science tricks that look like magic. Comes with the explanation, too.



FOR THE WHOLE TABLE

Herd Mentality

Try to give the same answer as everyone else. Big groups, lots of shouting.



FOR THE MINECRAFT FAN

LEGO Minecraft The Creeper

A big buildable Creeper, made to be displayed. For older fans.

See the full list for 10 year olds → momtriedthese.com/journal/gifts-for-10-year-olds

ONE LAST THING

Make the list before the sale

Sales are where good intentions go to buy a fifth stuffed toy. Write the list first, by name, then let the sale find you. If it isn't on the list, it isn't a deal.

More short lists

- Christmas gifts for kids 5 to 10
- Stocking stuffers they actually use
- For the Minecraft kid
- Quiet-hour activities, no screens
- Winter break: one plan a day

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